

Devise to advice

Dear Editor,

Earlier, Digit used to carry articles that were of interest to the common man such as an architect or a doctor. Today, the articles are about technology, security, Internet and some tests. The article on technology in combat was good, it touched the technology used in the Defence industry quite superficially. Also, there was no mention of technology used by the Indian Defence Forces.

The comparison tests dwell more on how the products are tested, and less about the product themselves. Earlier, every product was rated individually, with its pros and cons clearly spelled out. Now I have to run with a fine comb to find out if you have mentioned something about the product of my interest. Also, products should be tested for performance only, and not price, as they can be slashed. This is unjust not only to the product, but also to the reader.

I think that one CD is more than enough; there isn't much to offer in two CDs, and storage becomes a problem.

Most of the CDs that you offer with your subscriptions have only shareware or Freeware that is available in the Digit CDs. This time, when I renewed my subscription, I got royalty free Clip Art CD that I had already got as part of a previous subscription.

People like me, who are transferred from one city to another at regular intervals, find lugging along old issues of Digit very cumbersome. In my case, it has lead to a number of fights with my wife. It would be a lot better if the old issues could be given on a CD.

Ashish Rikhye

Via e-mail

Fastmail fanatic

My heartfelt sympathies to all those who are still stuck with their ailing Hotmail accounts. Reading all that useless spam everyday, and getting a measly 2 MB for storage space are just some of the irritating things a Hotmail user has to go through everyday. I did some research and zeroed in on one of the best e-mail providers-Fastmail (www.fastmail.fm). Fastmail has been hailed by several sources as the fastest and slickest e-mail service on the planet. I found it to be so. The interface is clean and uncluttered, and thus loads amazingly fast. It has hordes of features, many of which are customisable. Since I have switched to this service, I have not received a single spam! I am in no way connected with anyone associated with Fastmail, but I am simply in awe of the service. I think all Digit Readers must be informed of it.

Prayaas J. B. Rana

Via e-mail



Dear Praayas,

Thanks for the tip. Indeed many free e-mail service users could benefit from this. However, e-mail is a lot like a telephone number. If you use it a lot, then changing can be a big pain for people to get in touch with you. That's why for many who first get hooked on e-mail with Yahoo! or Hotmail, stay hooked.

Dear Ashish,

Thank you for sharing your ideas on how to improve the magazine. You will be glad to see that we are already implementing some of these changes. The comparison test format has been changing to individual product reviews over the last few months for most comparisons. While we continue to recommend products that give the best value for money, the performance rating is given for all individual product reviews.

We are already considering the possibility of making our issues available on CD, and the interest of preserving the domestic harmony of a loyal reader only lends more urgency to the matter!

Dear Gaurav,

The best way to place an order for an older copy of Digit would be at narayanan_r@jasubhai.com, or at the addresses and phone numbers provided on the services page. It is unlikely that the Digit Encyclopaedia of Technology subscription offer will be extended.

Your suggestions on A-List and Zero1 are interesting, and we will look at implementing them soon. However, it is not feasible to test last year's products in current comparison tests, unless they are still being sold by the company in question.

Agent 001 discovered many irregularities in the RAM market, including what turned out to be fake and substandard products labelled with most of the leading brands, making a comparison test a difficult proposition. We are going to highlight these problems in future issues. If our or any of our readers have had problems with fake branded products, we would like hear about them.

Queries and requests

Sumod,

How can I place an order for the past issues of Digit? I did not find any subscription form in the magazine, or on your Web site for ordering past issues at vintage prices.

I plan to subscribe Digit for one year from Jan 2004. But will the Digit Encyclopedia of Technology offer be extended that long? It would be wonderful if you could specify the month in which a particular product has been tested in your A-List. The same applies for your Zero1 awards too. You could also mention (at least) the former year's winners in the Zero-One awards, if they are not outdated.

I also request you to test the previous year's winners in the subsequent year's comparison tests. At least Agent 001 should test and survey the various brands of RAM available in India, and recommend or award the leading brands instead of testing them.

Gaurav Kale

Via e-mail

Short Bytes

I liked the September Issue very much. I got the solution of my problems before asking you. I found the answers to all my problems through QnA, even before I asked them! I also liked the 'Sound Advice' story, and have converted my old songs into digital music using the tool provided on Mindware. Can you test car stereo systems, cassette players, car CD players in the upcoming issue?

Raghav Ranjan

Via e-mail

I'll have to get into the habit of receiving surprises from Digit. Last year, I won a Celeron PC, and now a 3-month subscription!

Vikram Bhatia

Via e-mail

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